



FY27 ANNUAL BRAND PLAN · CONFIDENTIAL

Crunchwell: Reclaiming Relevance

A three-pillar platform to arrest a six-quarter share slide and re-anchor Crunchwell as the modern family-cereal brand.

Cory Whitman, Brand Director — Crunchwell

Acme Corp · Battle Creek, MI · \$812M ready-to-eat cereal · founded 1952

Planning cycle FY27 · drafted June 2026

THE PLATFORM PROBLEM

Executive summary

−2.1 pts

Category share lost
over 6 quarters

−5.9 pp

Relevance decline (lead
diagnostic)

**8% →
14%**

Price gap to Field &
Honey

\$312M

Crunchwell FY25
revenue

Crunchwell has lost 2.1 points of cereal category share between FY25Q1 and FY26Q2. The loss is not a price or promotion problem in the first instance — it is a **relevance** problem. Trust in the brand is intact and essentially flat (72.3 → 72.9 top-two-box); quality perception is stable. But relevance has fallen almost six points (68.6 → 62.7), and that is the attribute that predicts household acquisition in the modern family-cereal set.

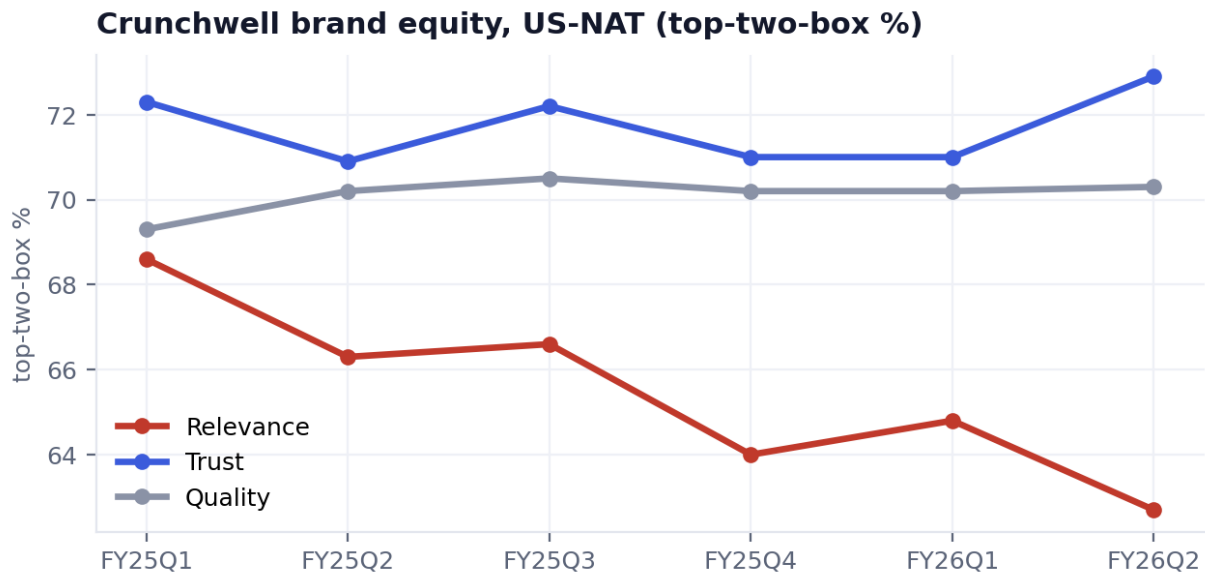
The share has gone to two places: Larksfield's Field & Honey (−1.3 pts of the loss) and private label (−0.6 pts), with the remainder to other branded players. Both winners share a positioning Crunchwell has ceded: "real, modern, better-for-you." The FY27 plan is built to win that ground back without abandoning the trusted, value-family core that still drives \$312M of revenue.

The FY27 thesis

Defend the core, modernize the message, and let ProteinPeak carry the wellness-migration demand we cannot meet inside the Crunchwell trademark. Relevance is the scoreboard.

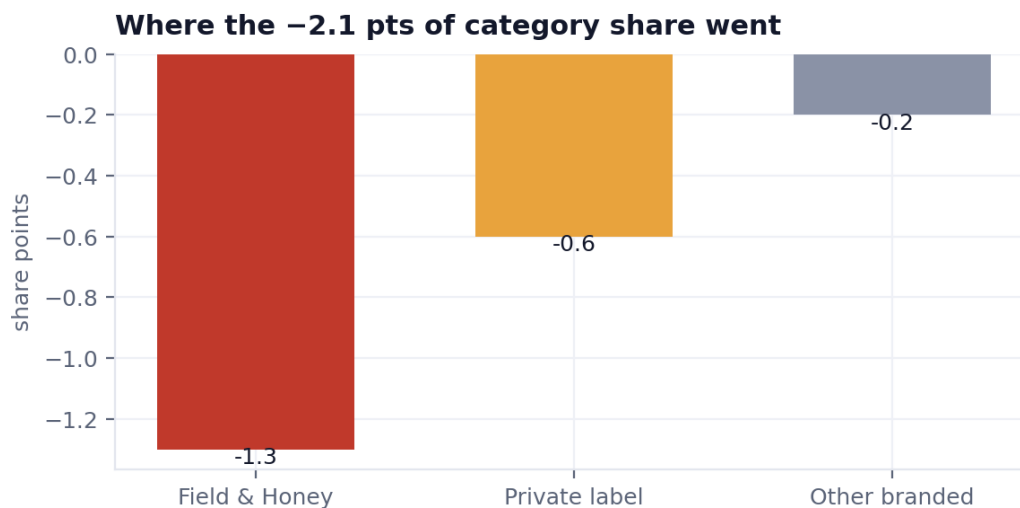
THE DIAGNOSIS

A six-quarter relevance slide

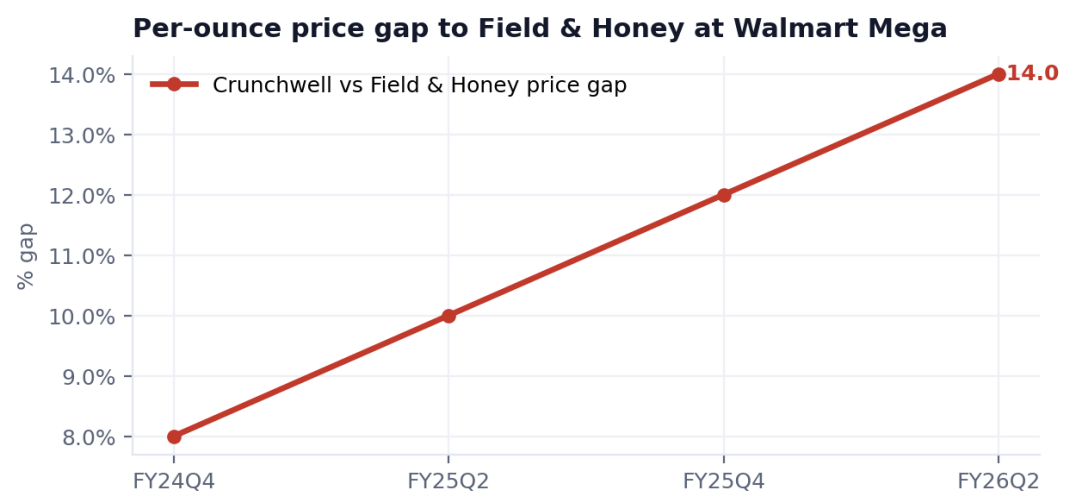


Relevance is the lead indicator. It began softening in FY25Q2 and has not recovered, falling to 62.7 by FY26Q2 — the lowest reading in the tracker's history. Trust and quality have held, which is the good news: the brand is not broken, it is dated. A relevance problem is fixable with message, pack and product news; a trust problem is not.

Where the share went

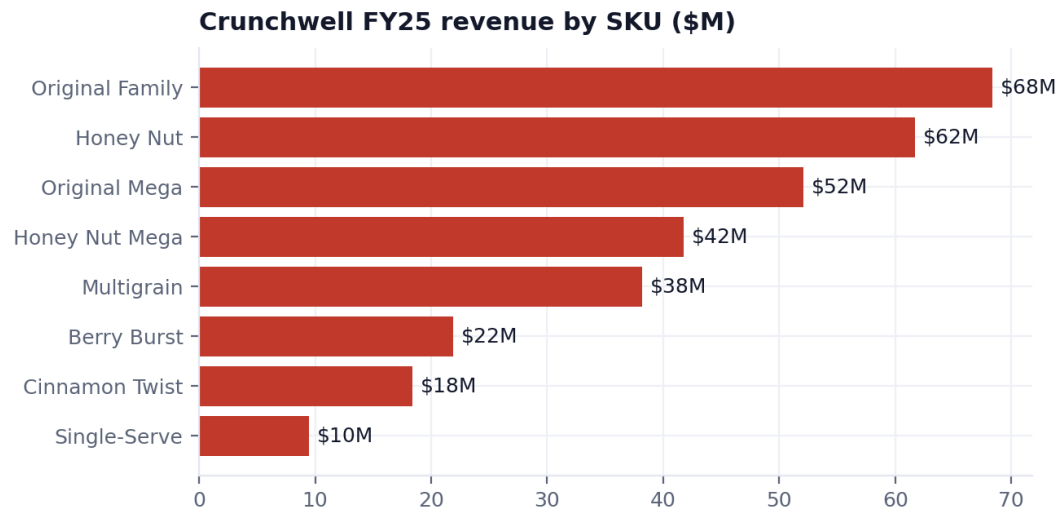


Field & Honey took the majority of the loss by out-positioning Crunchwell on "real grains, less sugar" while pricing at a widening premium we did not contest. The per-ounce price gap at Walmart Mega has doubled from 8% to 14% — meaning Field & Honey is winning on relevance *and* charging more for it. Private label captured the value-seeking tail, accelerated by the Louisiana facing losses.



THE PORTFOLIO

What we are defending



Original Family, Honey Nut and Original Mega are the franchise — together over \$180M and the SKUs that anchor the brand's trust equity. Cinnamon Twist (CR006) is the underperformer at 41% ACV and a sub-benchmark review profile; it is a reformulation-or-rationalize decision for FY27. Berry Burst is the one bright spot in the sweet tier and a template for relevance-forward news.

SKU	FY25 rev	ACV	Role in FY27
Original Family	\$68.4M	88%	Defend — trust anchor
Honey Nut	\$61.7M	81%	Defend — trust anchor
Original Mega	\$52.1M	76%	Recover Walmart facings
Honey Nut Mega	\$41.8M	64%	Recover Walmart facings
Multigrain	\$38.2M	58%	Relevance reset lead
Cinnamon Twist	\$18.4M	41%	Reformulate or rationalize

THE FY27 STRATEGY

Three pillars

Pillar 1 • Reset relevance with pack, product and message

- Pack refresh across the Mega and Multigrain lines, leading with "real grains, less sugar" — the exact ground Field & Honey occupies — supported by \$1.4M of LA-targeted media in Q3 as the test market.
- Reformulate Cinnamon Twist to a sugar-reduced spec or rationalize it; a 41%-ACV underperformer is dragging the sweet tier's relevance.

- Scale the Berry Burst playbook: it is the only Crunchwell SKU gaining, and it is gaining on news.

Pillar 2 · Defend distribution and recover Walmart facings

- Anchor the August Walmart line review on velocity-per-facing data to recover 2 facings on Original Mega and Honey Nut Mega — the FY26 facing cut is the single largest driver of the Louisiana decline.
- Hold private label at bay in the value tier with disciplined everyday-price architecture, not deeper promotion.

Pillar 3 · Let ProteinPeak carry the wellness migration

- Do not stretch the Crunchwell trademark into premium protein; the data shows the wellness-migration demand is real but belongs to ProteinPeak (53% net-new buyers at launch).
- Co-merchandise Crunchwell + ProteinPeak as the branded answer to private-label protein at captaincy retailers (see the Kroger Q3 JBR plan).

FY27 targets

Arrest the relevance slide and recover +2 pp of relevance (62.7 → ~65) by FY27Q4.

Recover +1.0 pt of category share, weighted to the Walmart facing recovery and the Mega/Multigrain refresh.

Hold the per-ounce price gap to Field & Honey at or below 12% through disciplined architecture.

Sources: brand_equity_quarterly (US-NAT), syndicated_weekly, competitor_launches, skus.csv, epos, perfect_store. All figures are from the Acme synthetic dataset.